

Refugee inclusion and the unmasking of AI models for the assistance of UNHCR operators.

Data & Innovation for Refugee Inclusion Hackathon

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● This article is more than 1 year old

UN aid agencies cut back operations after Trump's 90-day funding suspension

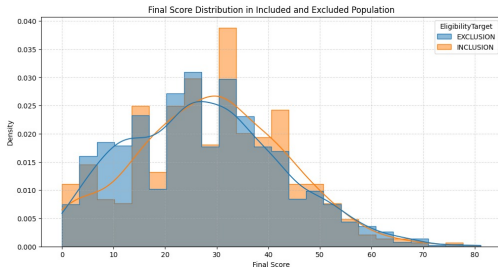
Exclusive: UNHCR chief orders clampdown on spending, including 90-day delay in ordering new supplies and hiring freeze



- cutting funds → overload of UNHCR workers
- use AI in humanitarian sector however we need to be aware

Q1 – Why is eligibility hard to predict?

It also depends on things not in the Scorecard data (e.g. budget, new arrivals expected)



Q2 – How to ensure override over AI decisions?

Human oversight is crucial. Operators answer for overriding a system they barely understand *and* assess each case alone: they tend to accept it.

Our approach

- From individual to institutional accountability ¹
- Algorithm-in-the-loop



Turning the problem on its head:

- No binary outcome
- Guiding, not suggesting

¹B. Green 2022, The Flaws of Policies Requiring Human Oversight of Government Algorithms

The K-Mazzu model

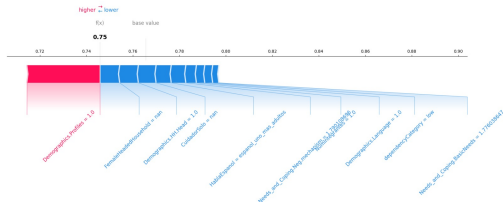
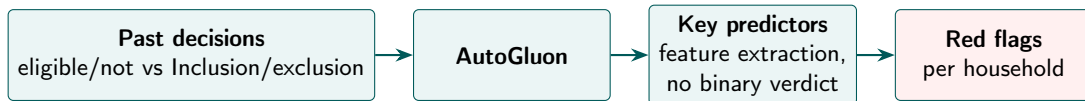


Figure: No high-risk profile

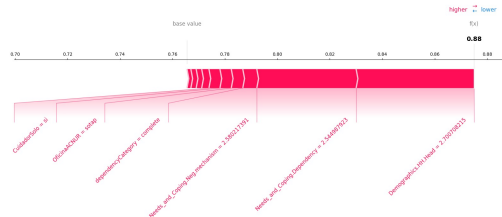


Figure: High-risk profile

Our approach: the Dashboard

HOUSEHOLD ASSESSMENT — 2023-03

Review household HH-0164

Review the household evidence, then record your own eligibility decision.

Assessment Interview notes

Setup field office

Interview completed

DATA STATUS

Finalizing decision

INTERVIEW RECORD

Open interview notes

VULNERABILITY SCORE

40.4 / 50

High

Sample mean: 25.7

+12.7 above mean

HOUSEHOLD SIZE

1 person

ADMINISTRATIVE CHECKS

No flags recorded

CONFIRM - INTERVIEW - DUPLICATE

What shapes this assessment

All eight scored factors, shown against the 50 sample median. Higher scores indicate greater vulnerability.

HOUSEHOLD FACTORS	SCORE	MEASURE	IMPORTANCE - GLOBAL
SOCIOGENETICS			
Head of household	1.00	1.00	10 number Should 1.00
Language barrier	1.00	1.00	10 number Should 1.00
Specific needs	3.58	1.00	100 number Should 1.00
Documentation	1.00	1.00	10 number Should 1.00
NEEDS AND COPIING			
Basic needs	1.78	1.78	10 number Should 1.00
Housing stability	3.82	2.15	12.7 number Should 1.00
Negative coping	3.58	1.78	118 number Should 1.00
Dependency burden	1.00	1.00	10 number Should 1.00

① The relevance of each factor to certain access (ACE) systems is 10 households. Most importance shows low global priority reason for eligibility flag. It does not show whether a factor alone or in combination, or explain the overall outcome. Negative coping is a vulnerability marker, with a probability of 10% a family will experience. Eligibility also depends on administrative criteria and available funding.

ADMINISTRATIVE CHECKS

Flags that may override the scorecard

Review these separately from household scored factors.

Asylum procedure (DMM)

No score modifier

0 recorded

Shared intentions

No flag recorded

0 recorded

Duplicate registration

No flag recorded

0 recorded

Additional household and interview context

ELIGIBILITY DECISION

✓ Your decision

Review the household information above and record your eligibility decision.

Finalize + Not eligible Record decision

- No AI verdict
- Key factors
- Tag for High Risk Profiles
- Available interview and full Scorecard if needed
- Operator decides

Conclusions

- Speeding case assessment through AI powered **complexity reduction**.
- No need for override monitoring: institutional accountability by design, algorithm-in-the-loop.
- Context awareness.

Thank you

Questions?

Thanks to UNHCR Innovation and the University of Trento for the challenge and the data.